



Incident and Near-Miss Reporting Procedure

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This procedure establishes the requirements for reporting, recording, investigating, and learning from incidents, near-misses, dangerous occurrences, and work-related ill-health events occurring in connection with the activities of Overleaf Publishers Ltd. It applies to all directors, employees, contractors, and, where relevant, learners. It fulfils the organisation's obligations under the Reporting of Injuries, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrences Regulations 2013 (RIDDOR) and supports continual improvement of health and safety performance. Document reference: HSW-002.

2. DEFINITIONS

TERM	DEFINITION
Incident	An unplanned event that results in, or has the potential to result in, injury, ill health, damage, or other loss
Near-Miss	An event that, under slightly different circumstances, could have resulted in injury, ill health, or damage — but did not
Dangerous Occurrence	A specified event that must be reported to the HSE under RIDDOR regardless of whether injury occurred (e.g. collapse of scaffolding, explosion, radiation incident)
Work-Related Ill Health	A condition caused or made worse by work activities, including occupational stress, musculoskeletal disorder, respiratory disease, and skin disease
RIDDOR-Reportable Injury	Death; specified injury (fractures, amputations, crush injuries, etc.); over-7-day incapacitation; occupational disease; dangerous occurrence

3. REPORTING OBLIGATIONS

All incidents and near-misses must be reported to the Director within 24 hours of occurrence or discovery. Reporting must not be delayed to await investigation. Reports are made via: email to info@chainsawcourses.com with subject 'INCIDENT REPORT'; verbal report followed by written confirmation within 24 hours; or self-reporting by the Director in the Incident Register.

4. RIDDOR STATUTORY NOTIFICATION

The Director is responsible for ensuring all RIDDOR-notifiable events are reported to the HSE within the required timescales:

EVENT TYPE — TIMESCALE	REPORTING METHOD
Death arising from work-related accident — without delay (within 10 days)	HSE RIDDOR portal online or telephone 0345 300 9923
Specified injury to a worker — without delay (within 10 days)	HSE RIDDOR portal online
Over-7-day incapacitation of a worker — within 15 days of incident	HSE RIDDOR portal online
Non-fatal accident to non-worker (visitor / public) — within 10 days	HSE RIDDOR portal online
Occupational disease diagnosis — upon receipt of confirmation	HSE RIDDOR portal online
Dangerous occurrence — without delay (within 10 days)	HSE RIDDOR portal online or telephone 0345 300 9923

5. INVESTIGATION PROCESS

All incidents and near-misses are investigated proportionately to their severity and learning potential:

SEVERITY — TIMESCALE	INVESTIGATION DEPTH
Low — within 10 working days (minor injury / near-miss, no recurring pattern)	Basic investigation: immediate cause; immediate corrective action
Medium — within 7 working days (significant near-miss; recurring pattern; moderate injury)	Intermediate: contributing factors; process review; corrective action plan
High — within 5 working days (RIDDOR-reportable; serious near-miss; pattern of incidents)	Full investigation: 5-Whys or fishbone root cause analysis; systemic corrective actions; management review input

6. INVESTIGATION METHODOLOGY

- Gather evidence: secure the scene (where applicable); preserve physical and documentary evidence; interview involved parties and witnesses promptly.
- Timeline reconstruction: establish the sequence of events leading to the incident.
- Immediate cause identification: what directly caused the incident?
- Root cause analysis: why did the immediate cause occur? Use 5-Whys or Ishikawa diagram for medium and high-severity events.
- Contributing factor analysis: what background conditions made the incident possible?
- Control gap analysis: which existing controls failed or were absent?
- Corrective and preventive actions: address root causes, not just symptoms. Actions logged in Nonconformance Register.

7. LEARNING AND COMMUNICATION

Investigation findings and lessons learned are: summarised in the Incident Register; communicated to relevant personnel to prevent recurrence; reviewed at the management review for trend analysis; and, where applicable, used to update risk assessments, safe systems of work, training content, or procedures.

8. INCIDENT REGISTER

The Incident Register is maintained by the Director and contains: incident reference; date and time; location; description; type (incident/near-miss/dangerous occurrence/ill health); injury/damage details; immediate cause; root cause; corrective actions; RIDDOR reference (if applicable); investigation completion date; and closure status. RIDDOR records retained for 10 years; all other incident records retained for 7 years.

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